

SEEWA

Empowering the Next Generation

Volunteer Handbook

Everything you need to know as a SEEWA volunteer

"Women — Powerhouse of a Nation"

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1. Welcome to SEEWA

Thank you for choosing to volunteer with SEEWA. Your commitment to empowering women and youth is what drives our mission forward. This handbook is your comprehensive guide to understanding our organization, your role, and how together we can create lasting change in communities across India.

"A world where every woman has the power to shape her destiny — creating environments for women's fullest potential and youth empowerment."

— Dr. Jyothi Para, Founder

As a SEEWA volunteer, you join a growing network of changemakers operating across Hyderabad, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, and beyond. With 20+ years of cross-cultural experience spanning India, Sri Lanka, and the USA, our founder Dr. Jyothi Para — who holds an Honorary Doctorate from The American University (USA) for women and socio-economic empowerment — has built SEEWA into a pan-India movement with 120+ women entrepreneurs in our network.

2. About SEEWA

Our Vision

A world where every woman has the power to shape her destiny. We envision creating environments where women can reach their fullest potential and youth are empowered to drive meaningful change in their communities.

Our Mission

To make women economic contributors to family and country — empowered and independent. We pursue holistic empowerment of women to be stakeholders in family, society, and politics through education, advocacy, and community support.

Core Values

Value	What It Means
Women Empowerment	Enabling women to be stakeholders in family, society, business & politics
Education	Youth capacity building, life skills, and primary school education across India
Health	Community health camps, Ayurvedic wellness & nutrition programs
Sustainability	Environmental conservation, organic farming, and sustainable practices

Advisory Board

- Mr. Kranthi Kumar — Auditor, Organic Agriculture
- Mr. M SS Ashok Babu — Additional SP (Police)
- Mr. Nuthan — Corporate Professional
- Mr. Nagaraju Ekula — Business Leader
- Smt. Usha Kiran Roy — IRS (Assistant Commissioner CGST)

Geographic Presence

Headquarters: Manasa Nest, MJ Colony, A.S. Rao Nagar, Hyderabad - 500040

Operations: Hyderabad, Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, pan-India

International: Sri Lanka & USA (cross-cultural programs)

3. Our Programs

SEEWA operates through four core programs, each addressing interconnected challenges that women and youth face — from economic independence to education to health and rights.

WEE — Women Entrepreneurship & Empowerment

Our flagship initiative formulating projects and policies to enhance self-sufficiency and sustainable development for India's women communities.

- Business Development: Direct assistance for entrepreneurs during their first 3 years — registration, accounting, planning, supplier connections
- Training & Skills: Technical skills, product development, soft skills, virtual workshops on networking and marketing
- Health & Wellness: Community health camps with Ayurvedic sessions, nutrition and stress management consultations
- Government Schemes: Awareness of financial subsidies, MSME/SME compliance, Stand Up India linkages
- Special Programs: Crochet & handicraft workshops, organic farming advocacy, financial literacy camps

YUVA — Youth Empowerment

Building capacity of youth and supporting primary school education across India through awareness, life skills, and career development.

- POSH & POCSO Workshops: Interactive sessions on sexual harassment prevention and child protection laws in schools and colleges
- Child Rights Awareness: Educational programs in urban and rural areas covering fundamental rights to education, health, and protection
- Life Skills Training: Communication, decision-making, emotional resilience, and teamwork for students and teachers
- Career Development: Exam and interview preparation, job-readiness training, internship programs for early-career professionals

PRERNA — Marketplace for Women Entrepreneurs

Dedicated marketplace initiative bridging women-led businesses and consumers through curated exhibitions and mentorship.

- Physical Marketplace: Curated exhibitions at premium venues (SVM Grand, Hyderabad) — handloom sarees, organic food, handicrafts, beauty products

- Mentorship: Comprehensive guidance on pricing, product presentation, customer engagement, and business acumen
- Digital Expansion: Online platforms to amplify reach, virtual networking events
- Key Event: Prerna Grand Inauguration by Nandi Award winner Mr. Ramky (November 2024)

CONNECT — NGO Strengthening & Collaboration

- DISHA Partnership: Joint community programs and volunteer engagement across Telangana
- Pride of Hyderabad: Community awareness campaigns and events
- Employee Volunteer Programs: Corporate volunteer engagement and event sponsorships
- Visibility Enhancement: Success stories, social media advocacy, community-based events

4. Volunteer Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Commitment	Location	Key Skills
Field Volunteer	2-3 days/week	On-site	Local language, empathy, basic training
Business Mentor	4-6 hrs/week	Remote/Hybrid	Business experience, mentoring, financial literacy
Education Volunteer	3-4 hrs/week	Remote/On-site	Teaching, patience, subject expertise
Health Volunteer	Flexible	On-site	Medical/health background, first aid

General Responsibilities (All Volunteers)

- Represent SEEWA professionally and uphold our values at all times
- Attend scheduled training sessions and orientation programs
- Maintain confidentiality of beneficiary information and organizational data
- Submit activity reports and feedback after each engagement
- Communicate proactively with your program coordinator about availability and challenges
- Participate in monthly volunteer meetups and quarterly reviews

5. Code of Conduct

As a SEEWA volunteer, you are an ambassador of our mission. Your conduct directly impacts the trust communities place in our organization.

Standards of Behavior

- **Respect:** Treat all beneficiaries, staff, and fellow volunteers with dignity and respect regardless of caste, religion, gender, or economic status
- **Integrity:** Be honest and transparent in all interactions. Never misrepresent SEEWA's services or make unauthorized commitments
- **Boundaries:** Maintain professional boundaries with beneficiaries. No personal financial transactions or romantic relationships
- **Inclusivity:** Embrace diversity. SEEWA works with women and youth from all backgrounds
- **Safety:** Follow all safety protocols. Report any concerns about beneficiary or volunteer welfare immediately
- **Confidentiality:** Personal information of beneficiaries is strictly confidential. Do not share on social media without explicit consent
- **Punctuality:** Honor your commitments. If unable to attend, notify your coordinator at least 24 hours in advance
- **No Discrimination:** SEEWA has zero tolerance for discrimination, harassment, or abuse of any kind

IMPORTANT: Violation of the code of conduct may result in immediate termination of volunteer status. SEEWA reserves the right to take appropriate action, including reporting to authorities if warranted.

6. Safety & Well-being

Your Safety Matters

- Always carry your SEEWA volunteer ID during field visits
- Never visit a community or beneficiary alone — always go with a team or coordinator
- Share your field visit location and expected return time with your coordinator
- Carry essential first-aid supplies during health camp volunteering
- Avoid handling cash — all financial transactions go through official SEEWA channels
- Report any uncomfortable or unsafe situations immediately to your program lead

Emergency Contacts

Contact	Number	When to Call
SEEWA Helpline	+91 96420 76369	General queries, scheduling
Program Coordinator	Assigned on onboarding	Program-specific issues
Emergency (Police)	100 / 112	Safety threats, crimes
Women Helpline	181	Harassment, domestic violence
Child Helpline	1098	Child welfare concerns

7. Communication & Reporting

Reporting Structure

All volunteers report to their assigned **Program Coordinator** who manages day-to-day activities. Program Coordinators report to **Dr. Jyothi Para (Founder)** and the Advisory Board.

Communication Channels

- **WhatsApp Group:** Primary channel for daily updates, scheduling, and quick queries (+91 96420 76369)
- **Email:** org.seewa@gmail.com for formal communication, reports, and documentation
- **Monthly Meetups:** In-person or virtual meetings for progress reviews and knowledge sharing
- **Social Media:** Tag @seewaglobal when sharing volunteer experiences (with beneficiary consent)

Activity Reporting

After each volunteer session, submit a brief report via the WhatsApp group or email covering:

- Date, location, and duration of activity
- Number of beneficiaries reached
- Activities conducted and outcomes observed
- Challenges faced and suggestions for improvement
- Photos (with consent) for documentation and social media

8. Our Impact & Achievements

Your volunteering contributes to SEEWA's growing impact. Here's what we've achieved together:

2024-2025 Highlights

Metric	Achievement
Online Workshops	31 sessions conducted
Exhibition Events	13 Prerna marketplace exhibitions
Business Promotions	10 online campaigns for women entrepreneurs
Expert Talks	6 women resource expert sessions
Offline Workshops	4 hands-on skill development sessions
Collaborations	4 inter-organization initiatives
Women Entrepreneurs	120+ in SEEWA's network
SDG Goals Aligned	8+ UN Sustainable Development Goals

Key Events Timeline

- **November 2024:** Prerna Grand Inauguration by Nandi Award winner Mr. Ramky at SVM Grand, Hyderabad
- **September 2024:** Crochet & Handicraft Workshop — WEE Program skills training for women entrepreneurs
- **August 2024:** POSH/POCSO Awareness Workshops in schools and colleges across Hyderabad
- **June 2024:** Life Skills Training for Youth — communication, decision-making & resilience workshops
- **May 2024:** Stand Up India Entrepreneurship Drive — MSME registration and financial literacy
- **April 2024:** DISHA Community Partnership Launch — joint volunteer programs across Telangana
- **Ongoing:** Prerna Marketplace exhibitions, health camps, child rights camps, organic farming advocacy

9. Policies & Procedures

Attendance & Leave

Volunteering at SEEWA is flexible, but we ask that you honor your commitments. If your availability changes, inform your coordinator at least 24 hours in advance. Extended absence (2+ weeks) should be communicated via email to org.seewa@gmail.com.

Social Media Policy

- You may share your SEEWA volunteering experience on personal social media
- Always tag @seewaglobal and use approved hashtags (#SEEWA, #WomenEmpowerment)
- Never share photos or stories of beneficiaries without their explicit written consent
- Do not make statements on behalf of SEEWA without prior approval from the communications team
- Represent SEEWA positively and professionally in all online interactions

Grievance Redressal

If you face any issues during your volunteering — whether related to safety, behavior, or organizational matters — you can raise a grievance through:

Step 1: Speak with your Program Coordinator

Step 2: Email org.seewa@gmail.com with subject line 'Volunteer Grievance'

Step 3: Contact Dr. Jyothi Para directly via the SEEWA helpline

All grievances are treated confidentially and resolved within 7 working days.

10. Resources & Support

Useful Links

- **Website:** seewa.org
- **Facebook:** facebook.com/seewaglobal
- **Instagram:** instagram.com/seewaglobal
- **LinkedIn:** linkedin.com/company/seewaglobal
- **YouTube:** youtube.com/@seewaglobal
- **WhatsApp:** +91 96420 76369

SDG Alignment Reference

SDG	Goal	SEEWA's Contribution
1	No Poverty	Employment training, entrepreneurship support, social protection
2	Zero Hunger	Nutritious food access, health camps, sustainable farming
3	Good Health	Maternal health, disease prevention, Ayurvedic wellness
4	Quality Education	Free education, early childhood development, vocational training
5	Gender Equality	Eliminating discrimination, women's leadership, POSH/POCSO
6	Decent Work	MSME empowerment, Stand Up India, youth employment
9	Innovation	Financial inclusion, digital marketplace, infrastructure access
10	Reduce Inequality	Income growth for bottom 40%, social & economic inclusion

Thank you for volunteering with SEEWA.

Your time, skills, and compassion make a real difference in the lives of women and youth across India. Together, we are building a future where every woman is empowered, every child is protected, and every community thrives.

Welcome to the SEEWA family.